CPSC 231 - Introduction to Computer Science for Computer Science Majors I

COURSE OUTLINE - Fall 2026

A. COURSE INFORMATION

1. Course Description & Learning Outcomes

Please see the university calendar for the course description and pre-requisites:

CPSC 231 https://calendar.ucalgary.ca/courses/1071641

By the end of this course, you will be able to:

- Read small procedural Python programs, identify any syntax any logic errors, identify type of data stored in specific variables and predict result of running code. This includes code that contains assignment, conditional and looping statements; arithmetic and boolean expressions; functions and recursive functions; input statements from the keyboard, mouse and files and output statements to the screen and files; creates new instances of classes and invokes methods on these instances and code that uses data structures such as lists and strings.
- Write and run small Python procedural programs that contains assignment, conditional and looping statements; arithmetic and boolean expressions; functions and recursive functions; input statements from the keyboard, mouse and files and output statements to the screen and files; creates new instances of classes and invokes methods on these instances and code that uses data structures such as lists and strings.
- Develop debugging skills to systematically identify and fix syntax and logic errors in procedural code written by self and others.
- Create basic classes in Python that contain a constructor, instance variables and methods.
- Design and implement a small application with a graphical user interface implemented using procedural Python code.

2. Instructional Team

Role	Name	Get in Touch By
Course Coordinator	Dr. Nelson Wong	TBD
Primary Instructor Lecture 01	Prof. James Tam	TBD
Primary Instructor Lecture 02	Farhad Maleki	TBD

3. Course Activities

Activity	Day/Time	Location
Lecture 01	MWF 13:00 - 13:50 - Online	

Activity	Day/Time	Location
Lecture 02	MWF 11:00 - 11:50	KNB 132
Tut 01	TR 08:00 - 08:50	MS 156
Tut 02	TR 09:00 - 09:50	MS 156
Tut 03	TR 10:00 - 10:50	MS 156
Tut 04	TR 11:00 - 11:50	MS 119
Tut 05	MW 14:00 - 14:50	MS 119
Tut 06	TR 15:00 - 15:50	MS 119
Tut 07	TR 13:00 - 13:50	MS 156
Tut 08	TR 08:00 - 08:50	BI 542
Tut 09	TR 09:00 - 09:50	ST 057
Tut 10	TR 10:00 - 10:50	ST 057
Tut 11	TR 11:00 - 11:50	ST 057
Tut 12	MW 14:00 - 14:50	SS 209
Tut 13	TR 15:00 - 15:50	SA 235
Tut 14	TR 12:00 - 12:50	MS 119

4. Course Resources

Course Site

D2L: CPSC 231 (Fall 2026)-Introduction to Computer Science for Computer Science Majors I

Optional Textbook

Ben Stephenson, *The Python Workbook A Brief Introduction with Exercises and Solutions (Third Edition)* : Springer.

Technology Required

In order to successfully engage in their learning experiences at the University of Calgary, students taking online, remote and blended courses are required to have reliable access to the following technology:

- A computer with a supported operating system, as well as the latest security, and malware updates;
- A current and updated web browser;
- Webcam/Camera (built-in or external);
- Microphone and speaker (built-in or external), or headset with microphone;

- Current antivirus and/or firewall software enabled;
- Stable internet connection.

For more information please refer to the UofC ELearning website: visit the UCalgary eLearning website: https://elearn.ucalgary.ca/technology-requirements-for-students

5. Assessment Components

Assessment	Due Date / Location	Weight
Assignment 1	Coding component: Oct 01, 2006. Demo component: during tutorials after code submission. Students must attend their enrolled tutorials.	15%
Assignment 2	Coding component: Oct 15, 2006. Demo component: during tutorials after code submission. Students must attend their enrolled tutorials.	15%
Assignment 3	Coding component: Nov 05, 2006. Demo component: during tutorials after code submission. Students must attend their enrolled tutorials.	15%
Assignment 4	Coding component: Nov 26, 2006. Demo component: during tutorials after code submission. Students must attend their enrolled tutorials.	15%
Registrar Final Exam	Scheduled by Registrar	40%

Detailed assessment information and expectations can be found on the course D2L.

Group Work Assessment

If group work is allowed for an assignment, it will be stated in the assignment descriptions. All group members must register for and attend the same tutorial. All members will receive the same grade by default, but grades could be adjusted based on contributions.

6. Letter Grade Conversion

Letter Grade	A+	A	A-	B+	B	B-	C+	C	C-	D+	D	F
Minimum Percent Required	95	90	85	80	75	70	65	60	55	50	45	< 45%

7. Missed Course Assessments

We understand that unexpected circumstances can arise during the term. The table below outlines what to do in different situations so we can help you as effectively as possible.

Assessment	What to Do	Options/Next Steps
Assignment 1 , Assignment 2 , Assignment 3 , Assignment 4	You will receive a late penalty for each day the submission is late. No assignments will be accepted over two days late.	In extenuating circumstances, you may email your TA and Head TA to request an alternative arrangement.
Final Exam	If you miss a Registrar-scheduled final exam, you must follow the Deferred Final Exam (DFE) process. Begin by visiting the Registrar's website for full instructions.	The Registrar will communicate with you regarding the status of your deferred exam application. If approved, the Registrar will post the date, time, and location of your deferred exam in your Student Centre.

Extended Absence / Significant Disruption: If you experience an interruption that affects multiple assessments or several weeks of learning, additional support may be needed. Please inform the instructional team via email as soon as you are able. You can consult the UCalgary Course Interruption resource for guidance: https://www.ucalgary.ca/current-students/course-interruption

B. COURSE POLICIES

1. Academic Integrity

Academic integrity is a core part of your learning and of our shared academic community. All work you submit must represent your own thinking and effort, unless collaboration or specific tools are explicitly allowed. Academic misconduct includes (but is not limited to) plagiarism, cheating, unauthorized collaboration, and the use of unapproved aids.

Below are the academic integrity expectations specific to this course:

Acceptable & Prohibited Tools & Resources

If you received aid from someone/AI other than a TA or course instructor when completing your assignment, you must indicate the source and extent of the aid. A citation should include the source (e.g., the person's name, book title, website URL, etc.) and a clear description of how this influenced your work.

All work submitted by students must be their own creation. Small amounts of code (1-3 lines) from external sources (including generative AI) may be used if cited via a comment, but if a significant portion (e.g., more than 10 per cent) of the work submitted by a student is taken from somewhere else, the student will not receive credit for the assignment even if the borrowed content is cited.

Please refer to the Policy of Coursework on D2L for details.

Exam Policy

No aids are allowed during examinations.

Resources & Support

The Student Success Centre offers workshops, tools, and a student academic integrity handbook to help you understand expectations and avoid common pitfalls. They also provide guidance on citation, collaboration, and working with sources. Learn more at: ucalgary.ca/student-services/student-success/learning/academic-integrity

GET SCIENCE DONE

If you ever have questions about how to apply academic integrity principles in this course, please reach out. We are here to help you navigate expectations and develop strong academic skills.

2. Grade Reappraisal

If you believe there has been an error in the marking of your work, you may request a grade reappraisal. The goal of this process is to ensure fairness and accuracy while maintaining consistent academic standards.

Informal Review

Email your TA regarding your concern. They will regrade your assignments if necessary.

Formal Grade Reappraisal Request

If concerns remain after discussions with the course instructor, you may submit a formal reappraisal request. A formal reappraisal may result in the grade being raised, lowered, or left unchanged. Please see the Faculty of Science guidelines on the grade reappraisal process: science.ucalgary.ca/current-students/undergraduate/science-advising/grade-reappraisals-and-appeals

3. Additional Course Policies

General Assignment Policy (see Policy of Coursework on D2L for more details):

1. You must not submit or look at solutions to the assignment problems that are not your own.

2. You must not share your solution code with other students, nor ask others to share their solutions with you.

3. You must indicate on your submission any assistance received.

C. SUPPORTS

You don't have to navigate university alone. Here are resources available to support your success and well-being:

Undergraduate Science Centre(USC)	Support for program planning, course selection, and academic regulations
Student Wellness Services	Physical and mental health support, including counselling, medical services, and wellness programs. ucalgary.ca/wellness-services/services
Student Success Centre	Help with study skills, writing support, time management, and academic strategy development. ucalgary.ca/student-services/student-success
Libraries and Cultural Resources	Research support, access to scholarly resources, citation help, and subject?specific librarians. library.ucalgary.ca
Safety Resources	Safewalk: 403-220-5333 | Campus Security: 403-220-5333 Available 24/7 for safety escorts, emergency response, and campus support.

For a comprehensive list of student wellness and safety resources, please visit: ucalgary.ca/registrar/registration/course-outlines

D. UNIVERSITY POLICIES

For detailed university policies, please consult the Academic Calendar at calendar.ucalgary.ca

1. Academic Accommodations

We are committed to supporting your learning. If you require academic accommodations, please follow the University of Calgary's established policies and procedures. Reaching out early helps ensure that the appropriate supports can be arranged.

Accommodations for Disability or Medical Conditions

Students who require accommodations related to a disability or ongoing/temporary medical condition should contact Student Accessibility Services (SAS). SAS works with students and instructors to set up academic accommodations such as extra time, note-taking support, or exam adjustments. Website: ucalgary.ca/student-services/access/

Accommodations Based on Other Protected Grounds

Students seeking accommodations based on protected grounds other than disability (e.g., religion, family status, gender expression or identity) should submit a Request for Accommodation in Academic Courses Form. Please email the completed form to science@ucalgary.ca at least 10 business days before the relevant assessment or planned absence.

2. Copyright and Intellectual Property

Course materials (including lectures, notes, assignments, exams) are the intellectual property of the instructor and are protected by copyright. Unauthorized sharing, distribution, or posting of course materials is prohibited and may result in disciplinary action under the Non-Academic Misconduct Policy. Students must read and comply with the University's Acceptable Use of Material Protected by Copyright Policy: ucalgary.ca/legal-services/university-policies-procedures/acceptable-use-material-protected-copyright-policy

3. UCalgary Notice of Collection

The University of Calgary (UCalgary) respects your privacy and is committed to ensuring the privacy of all students, staff, and community members. Your personal information is being collected under the authority of section 4(c) of the Protection of Privacy Act (POPA). It will be collected, used and disclosed for the purposes outlined in UCalgary's Notice of Collection, Use and Disclosure of Personal Information and managed in accordance with UCalgary's Privacy Management Program. Your personal information may be input into automated systems to generate content or make decisions, recommendations, or predictions. Assignments can only be returned to the student and will be accessible only to authorized faculty and staff. If you have questions regarding this notice or UCalgary's collection, use, or disclosure of your personal information, please contact accessandprivacy@ucalgary.ca.

Approval Date: Aug 07 2026 11:53

The University of Calgary, located in the heart of Southern Alberta, both acknowledges and pays tribute to the traditional territories of the peoples of Treaty 7, which include the Blackfoot Confederacy (comprised of the Siksika, the Piikani, and the Kainai First Nations), the Tsuut'ina First Nation, and the Stoney Nakoda (including Chiniki, Bearspaw, and Goodstoney First Nations). The City of Calgary is also home to Métis Nation within Alberta (Nose Hill Métis District 5 and Elbow Métis District 6).

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